

STARS@SLU 2025

ORIENTATION



Program Norms

1. Share talk time
2. Listen to understand
3. Everyone has expertise
4. Be present*
5. Critique ideas, not people
6. Embrace discomfort
7. Treat everyone with respect
8. Normalize time to think / process
9. others? changes?

Let's make a list for our program together!



Getting to know each other



Özlem Uğurlu
Director



Bryan Clair
Co-director



Cody Gilbert
Co-director



Alina
Abdurakhimova
*Graduate Assistant &
Mentor*



Sasha Trejo-Arciles
*Undergraduate Assistant
& Mentor*



Preetinder Kaur
*Undergraduate Assistant
& Mentor*

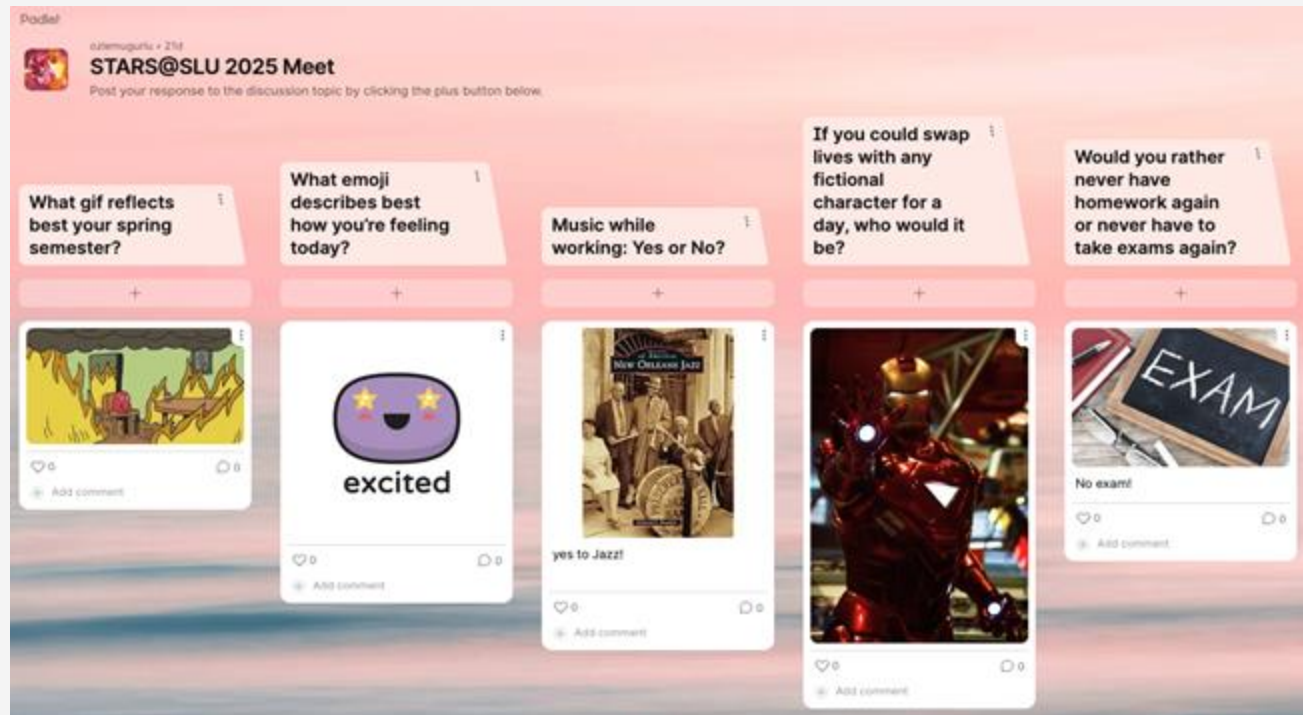


Ava Robertson
*Undergraduate Assistant
& Mentor*

Introduce yourselves; including name, school and grade!



Let's learn more about each other.



Outline of the Program

01

Week 1

Hands-on workshop
Sessions on Academic and Career
Growth
Mentoring sessions
Campus Tours
Game Sessions

02

Week 2

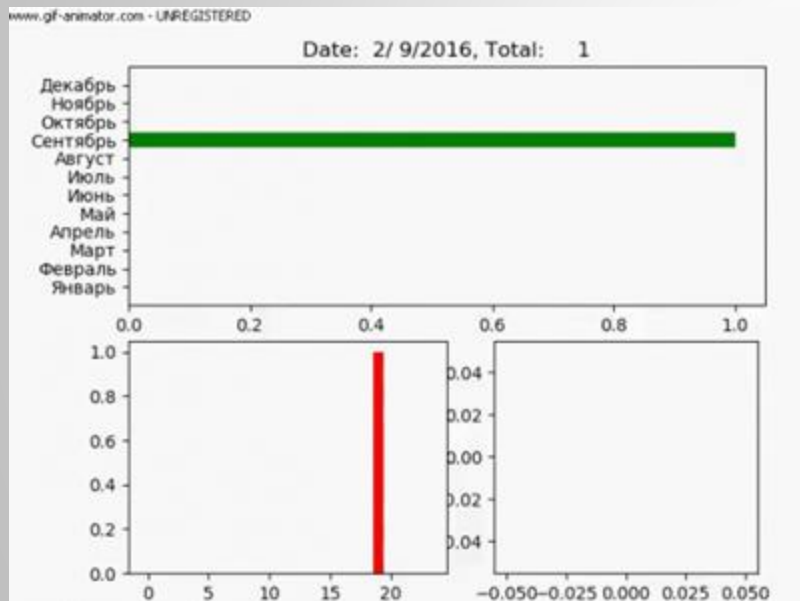
Group Projects
Poster Preparation Sessions
Mentoring Sessions
Invited Speakers
Game Sessions

03

Last Day

Poster Presentation
Certificate of Completion
Closing Remark & Reception

Research



- In the first week, you will attend a workshop series, two 1.5-hour sessions per day.
- The topics will include basic R usage, data cleaning and manipulation with dplyr, and data visualization with ggplot2.
- You will learn to create statistical and graphical summaries of data.
- At the end of the first week, you will be introduced to potential research projects and team up based on your shared interests.
- Throughout the second week, you will work in small groups on collaborative projects under the supervision and guidance of mentors.

Mentoring



Student mentors will support you through the program

Mentoring helps you:

- Build confidence and navigate challenges
- Develop a stronger sense of belonging in mathematical community
- Gain access to resources, networks, and opportunities
- Learn from someone who has been in your shoes

This is your support system. You're not alone in this journey.



Mentoring

- **Prior to your first meeting with your mentor, write down a few things you might want help with.** Rank the items in order of importance to you. Also write down things, if any, that concern you most about meeting with your mentor. Rank these things in order of importance.
- Write down things you would like your mentor to provide to make the most of the mentoring opportunity.
- **The focus of most successful mentoring is mutual learning.** Feel free to explore what you have to offer the mentor. A sense of humor and a sense of enjoyment of your time together are essential as well.

↓ Academic and Career Growth

Learning and development opportunities through panel and invited speaker sessions.

At a glance

- What to know about College Life
- How to apply to a College
- Summer Opportunities
- Careers in STEM



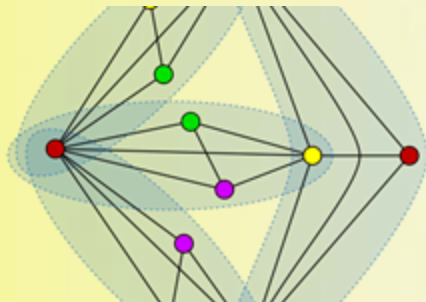


Game Session



01

Telestration



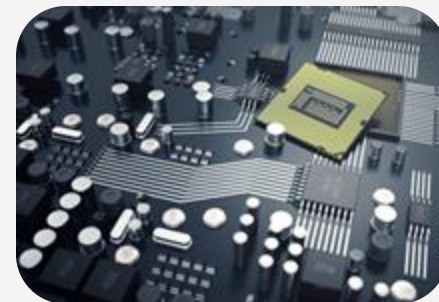
02

Function Battleship



03

Data Manipulation



04

Planar Graphs

05

Game of Fifteen



Invited Speakers



01

Literature

Dr. Ander Beristain &
Dr. Andre Zampaulo



02

Biostatistics

Dr. Nikki Freeman



03

Computer
Science

Dr. Abby Stylianou



04

Electrochemical
Engineering

Dr. Erfan Asadipour



05

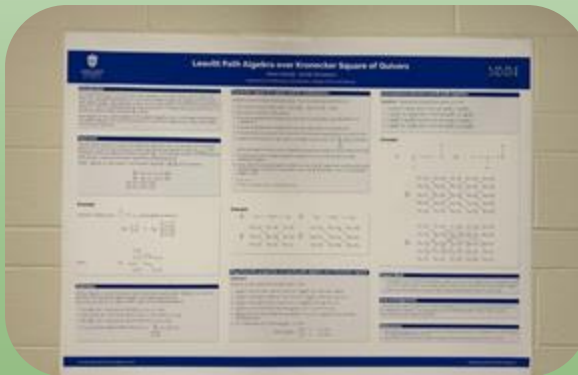
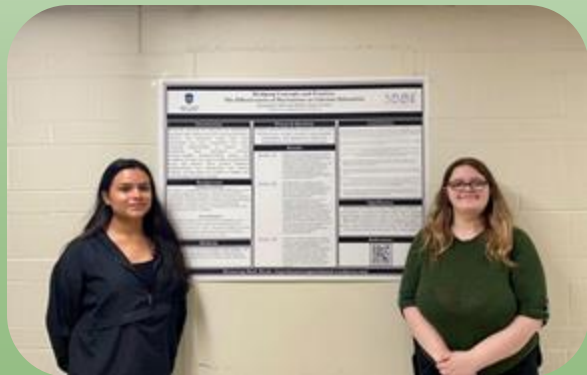
Chemistry

Dr. Michael Hankins



Poster Presentation

- Environmental Sustainability
- Healthcare Equity
- Health and Healing
- Education and Equity
- And more ...



Project details

Preparation Due Date: Make sure to prepare your posters by Thursday, August 7th, 5PM

Putting up the posters: Friday, August 8th, Noon - 1PM

Location: ISE Lobby

Poster Session: Friday, August 8th, 1-2pm

Feel free to invite anyone you'd like!

See the projects on our website: stars-slu.github.io/2025/

Checklist

Posting on
Social Media?
Tag MAA!

#MAAGrants
#MAAPrograms
#MAA
#MathGrants

01

Logistic

Breakfast:

In front of ISE 230

Sessions & Workshops:
ISE 230

Lunch: Grand Dining
Hall

Picnic on Wednesdays

02

Stipend and Travel
Support

Stipend & Travel:

Your information was
shared with the Post
Award Specialist, Sara
Baumann. Expect an
email from her.

Email:

sara.bauman@slu.edu

03

Signed Forms

1. SLU Photo
Release Form
2. Liability Waiver
3. Health Medical
Release Form
4. Community
Agreement Form

04

Program Materials

All the materials will be
available on GitHub site:
stars-slu.github.io/2025/



What is Next for the day?

01



Workshop - Part I

Team or lead: Led by Dr. Bryan Clair and Student Assistants

Objective: What is data? Computer files. Looking at data in a spreadsheet. R and the command line.

Time: 10 - 11:30 am

02



Workshop - Part II

Team or lead: Led by Dr. Bryan Clair and Student Assistants

Objective: Script files and the basics of programming. Loading data into R. Summary statistics, simple plots.

Time: 1 - 2:30 pm

03



Campus Tour

Team or lead: Will be led by Visit SLU Staff, starting from the ISE building

Objective: Explore the SLU North Campus

Time: 3 - 4 pm

04



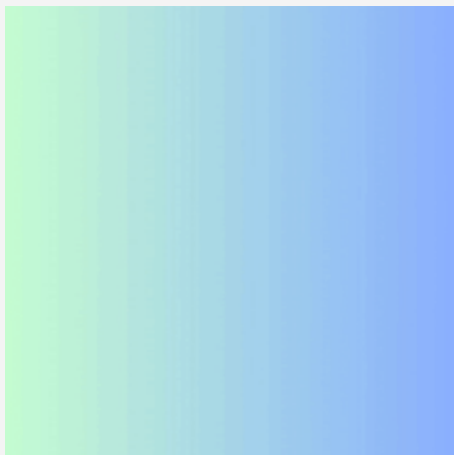
Mentoring Session

Team or lead: Led by Student Mentors

Objective: Meeting with mentors, setting goals



Thank you



Questions?

